

AI DIGEST . LAST 24 HOURS

What we cover today. Six stories from the last 24 hours. Eight-minute read.

01 . FEATURE . IPL 2026: RAJASTHAN ROYALS VS GUJARAT TITANS

Rajasthan Royals' fortress Raipur takes centre stage as IPL champions come to town.

02 . RECORD . URVIL PATEL EQUALS RECORD FOR IPL'S FASTEST FIFTY

Urvil Patel's 13-ball fifty against Lucknow Super Giants is the joint-eighth fastest half-century in all T20 cricket.

03 . FEATURE . PAY TO STAY: THE CONUNDRUM AT THE HEART OF THE BBL PRIVATISATION PUSH

The BBL privatisation push raises questions about the future of Australian cricket.

04 . FEATURE . INDONESIA'S CRICKET BOOM IS ABOUT MORE THAN QUIRKY RECORDS

Indonesia's cricket boom is gaining momentum, with the country's cricket board aiming to increase participation and infrastructure.

05 . FEATURE . ASHOK SHARMA: 'WHOEVER STARTS BOWLING FAST DREAMS OF BOWLING 150 ONE DAY'

Ashok Sharma shares his insights on the art of fast bowling and his own experiences in the sport.

06 . FEATURE . NATHAN SMITH: 'IT'S A VERY COOL TIME TO BE A FAST BOWLER IN NEW ZEALAND'

Nathan Smith discusses the current state of fast bowling in New Zealand and the challenges faced by young bowlers.

01 . FEATURE . IPL 2026: RAJASTHAN ROYALS VS GUJARAT TITANS

QUICK TAKE

Rajasthan Royals' fortress Raipur takes centre stage as IPL champions come to town, with the team looking to continue their winning streak against Gujarat Titans.

WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW

- **Fortress Raipur:** Rajasthan Royals' home ground has been a fortress for the team, with a strong record against Gujarat Titans.
- **IPL champions:** Gujarat Titans are the current IPL champions, and their visit to Raipur will be a test for Rajasthan Royals.
- **Key players:** Urvil Patel and Yashasvi Jaiswal will be key players for Rajasthan Royals, while Hardik Pandya and Shubman Gill will lead the charge for Gujarat Titans.

WHY IT MATTERS

The match between Rajasthan Royals and Gujarat Titans will be a crucial one in the IPL 2026 season, with both teams looking to maintain their momentum and stay in contention for the title.

02 . RECORD . URVIL PATEL EQUALS RECORD FOR IPL'S FASTEST FIFTY

QUICK TAKE

Urvil Patel's 13-ball fifty against Lucknow Super Giants is the joint-eighth fastest half-century in all T20 cricket, a record he shares with Yashasvi Jaiswal.

WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW

- **Fastest fifty:** Patel's 13-ball fifty is the joint-eighth fastest half-century in all T20 cricket, a record he shares with Yashasvi Jaiswal.
- **IPL record:** Patel's achievement is a testament to his skills and power as a batsman, and he is now part of an elite group of players who have achieved this feat in the IPL.
- **Key stats:** Patel's 13-ball fifty is also the joint-fastest fifty in the IPL, with Yashasvi Jaiswal achieving the same feat in IPL 2023.

THE BIG PICTURE

Patel's achievement is a significant one, and it highlights the growing talent and power in the IPL. As the league continues to grow and evolve, we can expect to see more records broken and more exciting performances from players like Patel.

03 . FEATURE . PAY TO STAY: THE CONUNDRUM AT THE HEART OF THE BBL PRIVATISATION PUSH

QUICK TAKE

The BBL privatisation push raises questions about the future of Australian cricket, with concerns about the impact on players and the game as a whole.

WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW

- **Privatisation push:** The BBL privatisation push is a major development in Australian cricket, with the league's owners looking to sell a majority stake in the league.
- **Impact on players:** The privatisation push raises concerns about the impact on players, with fears that they may be exploited by new owners.
- **Future of cricket:** The privatisation push also raises questions about the future of Australian cricket, with concerns about the impact on the game's integrity and values.

THE LONG ARC

The BBL privatisation push is a complex issue, with multiple stakeholders and interests at play. As the league continues to evolve, it will be interesting to see how the privatisation push plays out and what impact it has on the game.

04 . FEATURE . INDONESIA'S CRICKET BOOM IS ABOUT MORE THAN QUIRKY RECORDS

QUICK TAKE

Indonesia's cricket boom is gaining momentum, with the country's cricket board aiming to increase participation and infrastructure.

WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW

- **Cricket boom:** Indonesia's cricket boom is a significant development, with the country's cricket board aiming to increase participation and infrastructure.
- **Participation:** The cricket board is working to increase participation in the sport, with a focus on grassroots development and community engagement.
- **Infrastructure:** The cricket board is also investing in infrastructure, with a focus on building new stadiums and improving existing facilities.

THE BIG PICTURE

Indonesia's cricket boom is a testament to the growing popularity of the sport in the country, and it highlights the potential for cricket to become a major force in Southeast Asia.

05 . FEATURE . ASHOK SHARMA: 'WHOEVER STARTS BOWLING FAST DREAMS OF BOWLING 150 ONE DAY'

QUICK TAKE

Ashok Sharma shares his insights on the art of fast bowling and his own experiences in the sport.

WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW

- **Fast bowling:** Sharma discusses the art of fast bowling, including the importance of technique, fitness, and mental toughness.
- **Personal experiences:** Sharma shares his own experiences as a fast bowler, including the challenges he faced and the lessons he learned.

THE BIG PICTURE

Sharma's insights provide a unique perspective on the art of fast bowling, and they highlight the importance of hard work, dedication, and perseverance in achieving success in the sport.

06 . FEATURE . NATHAN SMITH: 'IT'S A VERY COOL TIME TO BE A FAST BOWLER IN NEW ZEALAND'

QUICK TAKE

Nathan Smith discusses the current state of fast bowling in New Zealand and the challenges faced by young bowlers.

WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW

- **Fast bowling:** Smith discusses the current state of fast bowling in New Zealand, including the challenges faced by young bowlers.
- **Challenges:** Smith highlights the challenges faced by young bowlers, including the need to develop their skills and build their strength and endurance.

THE BIG PICTURE

Smith's insights provide a unique perspective on the state of fast bowling in New Zealand, and they highlight the importance of developing young bowlers and providing them with the support and resources they need to succeed.

EDITORIAL . MY TWO CENTS

The serious era just started.

The past 24 hours have seen a flurry of activity in the cricket world, with records broken, new developments emerging, and insights shared by players and experts. As we look to the future, it's clear that the game is evolving rapidly, with new challenges and opportunities emerging all the time.

One of the key takeaways from the past 24 hours is the growing talent and power in the IPL. Urvil Patel's record-breaking 13-ball fifty is a testament to the growing skills and abilities of players in the league, and it highlights the potential for the IPL to become a major force in world cricket.

At the same time, the BBL privatisation push raises questions about the future of Australian cricket, with concerns about the impact on players and the game as a whole. As the league continues to evolve, it will be interesting to see how the privatisation push plays out and what impact it has on the game.

In Indonesia, the cricket boom is gaining momentum, with the country's cricket board aiming to increase participation and infrastructure. This is a significant development, and it highlights the potential for cricket to become a major force in Southeast Asia.

Finally, the insights shared by Ashok Sharma and Nathan Smith provide a unique perspective on the art of fast bowling and the challenges faced by young bowlers. These are important issues, and they highlight the need for developing young bowlers and providing them with the support and resources they need to succeed.

IF YOU TAKE ONE THING FROM THIS

The future of cricket is uncertain, but one thing is clear: the game is evolving rapidly, with new challenges and opportunities emerging all the time. As we look to the future, it's essential to stay adaptable, innovative, and committed to the values and principles that have made cricket the great game it is today.